



YT-DLP Studio

User Guide

Audio and video downloader with a graphical interface, built on yt-dlp

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1. What is YT-DLP Studio

YT-DLP Studio is a desktop application for downloading audio and video from YouTube and the hundreds of other sites supported by the **yt-dlp** engine. It gives you a simple graphical interface for the most common yt-dlp tasks — choosing format, quality and resolution, trimming a section, downloading whole playlists, managing a download queue — without typing any commands. It can also convert and compress files already on your computer.

The app manages its own dependencies: the first time it opens, it downloads **yt-dlp** and **FFmpeg** automatically and keeps them in its own folder. You don't need to install anything by hand.

Important: YT-DLP Studio is a front-end for yt-dlp — it does not host, store or distribute any content. Only use it to download videos you have the right to access, respecting each platform's terms of service and the creators' copyright.

2. First run

When you open the app for the first time, go to the **Queue & Log** tab to follow the status bar at the top:

- **yt-dlp**: a green dot with 'OK' means it's ready. If it's missing, the app downloads it automatically (small file, a few seconds).
- **FFmpeg**: needed to convert audio, merge video+audio and create covers. The first time, a ~80 MB package is downloaded — this can take a few minutes depending on your connection.

After this first download the files are kept permanently and the app starts instantly afterwards. If you ever need to reinstall them (for example, if they were deleted or corrupted), use '**Check / Reinstall Dependencies**' on the Queue & Log tab.

These files live in a folder called '**data**', created right next to the program itself (not in any hidden Windows folder). Click the folder icon next to 'Update yt-dlp' to open it at any time.

3. Main window overview

The main window has four tabs, always visible at the top:

- **AUDIO** — download music/podcasts, converting to MP3, FLAC, WAV, etc.
- **VIDEO** — download full videos, choosing resolution and format.
- **CONVERT** — convert or compress files already on your computer.
- **Queue & Log** — follow downloads in progress, manage the queue and see a detailed log of everything the app is doing.

Four buttons sit in the top-right corner: the gear opens **Settings**, the question mark (?) opens the built-in quick guide, the moon/sun icon switches between dark and light theme, and the 'PT'/'EN' button switches the interface language.

4. Audio tab

Use this tab to download only the audio of a video (ideal for music).

Playlists and albums

If the pasted link is a playlist or album, the app detects it automatically and creates a subfolder named after the playlist inside your music folder — every track is saved there instead of loose in the main folder. The cover is saved as **playlistcover.jpg** in that same subfolder once the download finishes.

Link box and automatic lookup

Paste the video, playlist or album link into the text box at the top. To download several links at once, paste one per line — the app creates a separate download item for each.

When there is **exactly one** link, as soon as you stop typing the app looks up the title, artist and duration in the background, filling in the fields below and adjusting the trim bar automatically. This never blocks anything: you can click Download at any moment, even before the lookup finishes. With several links pasted at once the lookup is skipped (so one track's data isn't applied to the others by mistake).

Format and Quality

The **Format** menu sets the final audio file type: Best available (no re-encoding, fastest), MP3, M4A, AAC, Opus, Vorbis, FLAC (lossless), ALAC (lossless, Apple standard) or WAV (uncompressed). The **Quality** menu sets the encoding bitrate, from 32 to 320 kbps — 320 kbps (the highest) is selected by default.

Title and Artist

Filled in automatically by the lookup above when there is a single link (and still editable). Whatever is in these fields at download time replaces the original title/artist in the file's metadata (ID3) — useful when the YouTube title isn't exactly the track name. **The file name, however, always uses only the title** — the artist never appears in front of the file name, even when the field is filled in; it only affects the internal MP3/FLAC/etc. metadata. For **playlists**, Title and Artist are ignored — each track uses its own title/artist (otherwise every track would end up in the same file).

Save thumbnail

When checked, saves the cover as a separate **.jpg** file in the destination folder. For music the cover is always **cropped 1:1** (square, the standard album-cover shape); for video it keeps the original thumbnail's size and proportions, uncropped. For a **playlist**, only the playlist's own cover is kept (playlistcover.jpg) — not one cover per track.

Check playlist availability

The button next to 'Save thumbnail' tests every track of the pasted link without downloading anything and writes each unavailable track to the Log (Queue & Log tab) with its position and neighbouring tracks — e.g. *12 - Name — after "A" and before "B"* — plus the reason. Large playlists take a few minutes.

5. Video tab

Works like the Audio tab but downloads the full video — including the automatic duration lookup when a single link is pasted (there are no title/artist fields here). The final file is named **'Title - Channel'**, to tell apart re-uploads of the same video on different channels.

- **Resolution:** from 144p up to 4320p (8K), or 'Best available'.
- **FPS:** caps the frames per second (60/30/24) or 'Best available'.
- **Video/audio codec:** preferred codec (H.264, H.265, VP9, AV1, VP8 for video; AAC, Opus, MP3, FLAC for audio). If that exact combination doesn't exist for the link, the app falls back to the best available option automatically, so a download never fails just because of this preference.

- **Container:** 'Automatic' lets yt-dlp pick MP4 or MKV based on codec compatibility; 'Force MP4'/'Force MKV' converts the final file to that format when needed.
- **Subtitles:** when checked, downloads and embeds subtitles (language and format are set in Settings → Extra files).

6. Trimming a section

Right below the link box, a two-handle bar lets you pick a time range. Drag the circles to the desired position, or type the time directly into the '00:00:00' fields on each side (HH:MM:SS format).

If both handles stay at the ends (the default), the whole video/track is downloaded — trimming only applies when you actually move the handles or edit the time fields.

7. Download now vs. download queue

Button	What it does
Download (red, large)	Starts downloading right away. If something is already running, the new item joins the queue and starts when its turn comes.
+≡ (gray, beside it)	Only adds the link to the queue without starting. Use it to line up several downloads and run them all later.

To start items that were only added to the queue, go to the **Queue & Log** tab and click '**Start Queue**'.

8. Convert tab and Queue & Log tab

Convert

Converts or compresses files already on your computer, using the same FFmpeg the app downloads on its own. Pick the file, the **format** (MP3, M4A, Opus, FLAC, WAV, MP4 H.264, MKV H.265, WEBM VP9), the **quality** (High = bigger file, Low = smaller file) and, for video, the maximum **resolution** (it never upscales). The result is saved next to the original as *name_convertido.ext*, with a progress bar and a cancel button (an unfinished file is deleted).

Target-size compressor: type a number in **Target size** and pick **MB** or **GB** beside it (e.g. *25 MB* to fit an e-mail attachment, *1.5 GB*). The app reads the file's duration and calculates the bitrate to reach that size — the result lands slightly under the target. When this field is filled in, Quality is ignored; leave it empty to use the normal quality presets. It doesn't apply to FLAC/WAV (lossless), and targets too small for the video's duration are refused with a message in the Log.

Queue & Log

This tab is where you follow everything:

- **Status bar** — shows whether yt-dlp/FFmpeg are ready, with buttons to check/reinstall dependencies, update yt-dlp to the latest version (recommended when downloads start failing for no obvious reason — sites change often and this usually fixes it), and a folder icon that opens where those files live.
- **Queue list** — each item shows its title and its own progress bar. During a playlist download the text changes to 'Title - Artist (X of Y)', showing exactly which track is downloading. The running item has its own cancel button.

- **Control buttons** — Start Queue, Cancel Current Download, Clear Finished (removes only finished items) and Clear All (empties the whole queue, except the running item).
- **Log** — detailed text of every yt-dlp step in real time. Use 'Copy' to paste it into a message if you need help with a specific error.

9. Settings — Folders and Network

Folders

Sets where music and video files are saved by default (`%USERPROFILE%\Music\Download` and `%USERPROFILE%\Videos\Download`, resolved for the current Windows user). The 'Change folder' link on each tab is a quick shortcut to the same setting.

Network

- **Speed limit** — e.g. 2M (2 MB/s) or 500K (500 KB/s), so large downloads don't saturate your connection.
- **Proxy** — address of a proxy server, if you use one.
- **Playlist items** — download only part of a playlist, e.g. '1-5,8,10-13' downloads tracks 1 to 5, 8, and 10 to 13.
- **Filename template (advanced)** — for advanced users who know yt-dlp's template syntax (e.g. `%(artist)s - %(title)s.%(ext)s`). Leave empty to use the app's default.

10. Settings — Filters

Skip videos outside certain criteria before the download even starts — useful for large playlists and channels.

- **Uploaded after / before** — filter by upload date (YYYYMMDD format).
- **Minimum/maximum file size** — e.g. 10M, 2G.
- **Minimum/maximum duration (s)** — in seconds; handy for skipping shorts or long livestreams when downloading a whole channel.

11. Settings — Download behavior

- **Restrict filenames** — plain ASCII characters only, avoiding any compatibility issue on Windows.
- **This video only** — if the link belongs to a playlist, download only that video and ignore the rest.
- **Skip already downloaded** — keeps a history file so the same video is never downloaded twice, even across sessions.
- **Bypass geo-restrictions / Ignore SSL certificate errors / Force IPv4** — network options to get around specific blocks.
- **Save video comments** — writes the comments to a separate file.
- **Livestreams: download from the start** — for streams already in progress, records from the earliest available point instead of the current moment.
- **Force Windows-safe names** — full Windows filename compatibility while keeping accents and unicode characters.
- **Do not overwrite existing files** — skips the download if the destination file already exists.

- **Parallel fragments / Retries on error / Retries per fragment / Pause between downloads** — fine-tuning for speed and connection reliability; yt-dlp's defaults work well in most cases.

12. Settings — Extra files and album cover

- **Embed metadata and cover art** — writes title, artist, year and the cover directly into the final file (recommended, on by default). For music the cover is always cropped 1:1 automatically — there's no option to turn that off, since there's no reason to want a non-square music cover.
- **Embed chapters / Split into files by chapter** — for videos with marked chapters (common in podcasts and full albums on YouTube).
- **Save description file / info file (.info.json)** — writes extra text files with the video's description and full metadata.

Save album/playlist cover in folder

On by default. When a whole playlist finishes downloading (in its own subfolder, as explained in section 4), the app saves the playlist's cover as **playlistcover.jpg** inside that subfolder — so you can tell the playlist's cover at a glance.

13. Language and theme

The 'PT'/'EN' button in the top-right corner switches the whole interface between Portuguese and English instantly. The moon/sun icon switches between dark and light theme. Both preferences are saved and remembered the next time the app opens.

The interface colours follow yt-dlp's own visual identity: black, white and pure red (#FF0000) for the main buttons and highlights, in both themes.

14. Tips and troubleshooting

- 1 **Download failed with a strange error:** on the Queue & Log tab, click 'Update yt-dlp'. Sites like YouTube change often, and this fixes the vast majority of errors.
- 2 **FFmpeg never finishes downloading:** check your internet connection and try 'Check / Reinstall Dependencies' again. The package is about 80 MB.
- 3 **Video unavailable/private:** the link may have been removed or made private by its author — that's not a problem with the app. Use 'Check playlist availability' to find which tracks of a playlist are affected.
- 4 **I want to see exactly what yt-dlp is doing:** watch the Log panel in real time, or copy its content with the 'Copy' button.
- 5 **Filenames with odd characters:** enable 'Force Windows-safe names' or 'Restrict filenames' in Settings.

15. Legal notice

YT-DLP Studio is a personal-use graphical interface built on the open-source **yt-dlp** project (released under the Unlicense, public domain). The app does not bypass any paid-content protection (DRM) and does not host, redistribute or store third-party files.

It is the user's responsibility to respect the Terms of Service of the platforms content is downloaded from and the creators' copyright. Use it for personal backups, your own content, or material explicitly licensed for download.